

HONOR IN THE CHAIRMANSHIP

By Misheck Mwanza (Mishcool)

DEFINITION OF CHAIRMANSHIP

Chairmanship is the role and responsibility of leading and guiding meetings in an orderly, fair, and disciplined manner. It involves presiding over discussions, ensuring that procedures are followed, allowing equal participation, and guiding members toward clear decisions.

In organized institutions such as schools, churches, and community groups (including the SDA Church), chairmanship emphasizes order, respect, neutrality, and effective leadership, rather than personal authority. Honor in chairmanship means leading responsibly, promoting unity, and ensuring that meetings achieve their intended purpose.

WHO IS A CHAIRPERSON?

A chairperson (also called chair, chairman, or chairwoman) is an elected or appointed official who leads meetings and oversees discussions. The chairperson does not dominate the meeting but guides it according to agreed rules and procedures.

The chairperson represents authority, neutrality, and order during meetings.

IMPORTANCE OF CHAIRMANSHIP

Maintains order and discipline in meetings

Ensures fair participation

Guides decision-making

Protects the rights of members

Ensures meetings achieve their objectives

Without proper chairmanship, meetings become disorganized and unproductive.

QUALITIES OF A GOOD CHAIRPERSON

A good chairperson should have the following qualities:

1. Impartiality – Treats all members fairly without favoritism
2. Leadership – Guides discussions confidently
3. Good communication skills – Speaks clearly and listens attentively
4. Knowledge of rules – Understands standing orders and procedures
5. Patience and self-control – Manages conflict calmly
6. Confidence – Commands respect
7. Integrity – Honest and trustworthy
8. Time management – Keeps meetings focused and on schedule

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF A CHAIRPERSON

Calling the meeting to order

Confirming quorum

Guiding discussions

Allowing members to speak in turn

Maintaining discipline

Putting motions to vote

Announcing decisions

Ensuring rules are followed

Closing the meeting

PROCEDURE OF A MEETING

A meeting chaired properly follows a clear procedure:

1. Opening the meeting

Welcome members

Call meeting to order

2. Confirmation of quorum

Ensure required number of members is present

3. Reading and confirmation of minutes

Secretary reads previous minutes

Members confirm or correct

4. Matters arising

Discuss unresolved issues from previous meeting

5. Agenda items

Discuss new matters

Motions proposed and seconded

6. Voting

Decisions made by majority

7. Any other business (AOB)

8. Closing the meeting

MOTIONS IN A MEETING

A motion is a formal proposal presented for discussion and decision.

Steps of a Motion

1. Proposal by a member

2. Seconding by another member

3. Discussion

4. Voting

5. Chairperson announces the result

ROLE OF THE SECRETARY

The secretary works closely with the chairperson and plays a vital role in meetings.

Duties of the Secretary

Preparing the agenda

Notifying members of meetings

Recording minutes

Reading minutes during meetings

Keeping records and documents

Handling correspondence

The secretary ensures continuity and accurate documentation of decisions.

RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN CHAIRPERSON AND SECRETARY

The chairperson leads the meeting

The secretary records proceedings

Both must cooperate respectfully

Good teamwork ensures successful meetings

DISCIPLINE AND ORDER IN CHAIRMANSHIP

The chairperson maintains order by:

Enforcing rules

Preventing interruptions

Handling disagreements fairly

Ensuring respectful language

This reflects honor and professionalism in leadership.

HONOR IN THE CHAIRMANSHIP

Honor in chairmanship is demonstrated through:

Fair leadership

Respect for members

Transparency in decisions

Observing procedures

Serving the group, not personal interests

CONCLUSION

Chairmanship is a position of trust and responsibility. When exercised with honor, it promotes unity, efficiency, and respect in meetings and organizations. A good chairperson leads with fairness, discipline, and integrity for the benefit of all members.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Define chairmanship.

2. Who is a chairperson?
3. State five qualities of a good chairperson.
4. Explain the duties of a chairperson.
5. Outline the procedure of a meeting.
6. What is a motion?
7. Describe the role of the secretary.
8. Explain the relationship between the chairperson and the secretary.
9. Why is discipline important in chairmanship?
10. Explain what is meant by honor in the chairmanship.